

Jhinga *Achari* Fry

from the kitchen of Noor

A PLATEFUL OF PRAWNS · QUICK FRY, BIG FLAVOUR

Prawns marinated in a pickle-spiced masala, then fried till they catch at the edges. The spoonful of achar — mango, tomato, whatever's open in the fridge — is the trick: it gives the whole thing that tangy, pickly kick. Wonderful with rice and dal, or just rice and a bit of chutney.

a photo of the jhinga fry goes here ♦

crisp at the edges, curry leaves and all

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

FOR THE PRAWNS & MARINADE

- prawns (jhinga), heads & tails removed, washed
- ginger-garlic paste, a good spoon
- turmeric (haldi), a pinch
- red chili powder (mirchi), to taste
- salt (namak), to taste
- coriander powder (dhania) — a little extra
- cumin powder (jeera)
- kalonji (black seeds)
- cumin seeds (zira)
- a spoon of achar — mango, tomato or mixed-veg pickle

FOR FRYING & FINISHING

- oil, for a hot shallow fry
- a sprig of curry leaves
- chopped coriander leaves, to garnish

Any pickle you have works — the achar is what makes it "achari." Start with a small spoon and taste.

HOW WE MAKE IT

- 1 **Prep the prawns.** Remove the heads and tails, then wash the prawns well and drain.
- 2 **Marinate.** Add ginger-garlic paste, turmeric, chili powder, salt, a little extra coriander powder and cumin powder. Then add the kalonji (black seeds) and cumin seeds.
- 3 **The achari touch.** Stir in a spoon of whatever achar you have — mango, tomato or mixed-veg pickle. Mix well and let it marinate a while.
- 4 **Heat the oil.** Get the oil hot in a pan and drop in the curry leaves to let them crackle.
- 5 **Fry the prawns.** Lay the prawns in one by one and fry — turning — until they're cooked through and catching at the edges.
- 6 **Finish.** Garnish with chopped coriander leaves. Serve hot with rice and dal, or rice and chutney.

Amma's note: don't crowd the pan — lay the prawns in one by one so they fry, not steam. And don't overcook them; prawns are done the moment they curl and turn opaque.